

BEXO

BACK YOURSELF. GET SEEN.

Complete Product Requirements Document

Candidate-first talent marketplace with paid visibility

Version 1.0 | 27 August 2026

Working brand name: BEXO. Trademark, company name, app-store, and domain clearance are still required.

Document Control

Item	Value
Product	BEXO
Document	Product Requirements Document
Version	1.0
Date	27 August 2026
Status	Build-ready product specification
Primary market	Candidate-first talent discovery
MVP geography	Single launch market recommended; see launch section
Working model	\$10 candidate-paid visibility boost
Research basis	Current web verification of Pozy and adjacent candidate marketplaces; legal/payment requirements treated as launch checklists, not legal advice

Executive Summary

BEXO is a candidate-first talent marketplace. A person looking for work creates a rich public professional profile using their resume, LinkedIn, GitHub, portfolio, experience, projects, skills, education, compensation preferences, availability, and other professional evidence. The profile can be discovered by employers, recruiters, founders, and other permitted visitors. The candidate may optionally pay a small fee (initially proposed at \$10) to receive prominent placement on the talent board for a defined period.

The fee is a visibility purchase and a voluntary confidence signal. It is not a qualification score, endorsement, verification, or guarantee of hiring. BEXO must make this distinction explicit in product copy, ranking UI, terms, and analytics.

The closest product inspiration is Pozy's current pay-to-rank public job board. Pozy states that rank is bought, the board is ordered by highest bid, and payment buys placement rather than a hiring outcome. BEXO flips the object being promoted: the candidate is the listing. See Section 35 for reference URLs and research notes.

1. Product Thesis

Traditional hiring starts with a company posting a job and candidates applying. BEXO starts with the individual. The candidate publishes a professional profile and actively chooses whether to increase visibility. Employers discover people first and then initiate contact.

The product is therefore best understood as a talent marketplace with a paid self-promotion layer, not as a resume builder or conventional job board.

Core value proposition

For candidates: “Build one strong professional profile, put yourself in front of opportunity, and let employers evaluate your actual work.”

For employers: “Browse people who have actively made themselves discoverable and contact promising talent directly.”

Core mechanic

Free profile -> publish -> optional \$10 featured boost -> prominent placement -> employer discovery -> profile view -> direct contact -> interview -> potential hire.

2. Goals and Non-Goals

Goals

- Create a high-quality public professional profile from multiple sources, starting with resume upload plus external links.
- Make active job seekers discoverable without requiring a matching job posting.
- Create a simple, understandable paid-visibility product for candidates.
- Provide direct, consent-aware candidate contact.
- Build trust using verification signals, evidence, moderation, and strong privacy controls.
- Prove marketplace liquidity before adding complex auctions or employer monetization.
- Measure whether paid visibility creates incremental qualified opportunity.

Non-goals for MVP

- Replacing LinkedIn as a social network.
- Building a full applicant tracking system.
- Guaranteeing jobs or interviews.
- Using payment as evidence of talent quality.
- Launching a complex live auction on day one.
- Automating employment decisions with AI.

3. Users and Roles

Role	Primary need	Key actions
Candidate	Get discovered and contacted	Create profile, publish, boost, manage visibility, receive contacts
Employer / recruiter	Find relevant people quickly	Search, filter, view profiles, save, contact
Public visitor	Explore talent	Browse public profiles subject to visibility settings
Moderator	Keep marketplace trustworthy	Review reports, remove abuse, manage appeals
Admin / operator	Operate marketplace	Payments, users, boosts, analytics, configuration
Support	Resolve issues	Account, payment, privacy, moderation support

4. Personas

Candidate: active job seeker

Example: Rahul, 27, AI engineer, 4 years of experience, has a resume, LinkedIn, GitHub and portfolio. He is tired of sending applications into ATS systems. He wants more employer exposure without paying a recruiter or an agency.

Candidate: passive professional

Example: Sarah is employed but open to exceptional opportunities. She needs strong privacy controls and may choose an anonymous or recruiter-only mode rather than a fully public profile.

Employer: founder / hiring manager

Example: a startup founder wants an AI engineer and prefers directly reviewing people who are actively open to opportunities rather than processing hundreds of applications.

Employer: recruiter

Example: a recruiter searches by role, skills, location, availability and experience, then contacts candidates whose profiles are relevant.

5. End-to-End Journeys

Candidate journey

1. Create account
2. Upload resume
3. Add LinkedIn, GitHub, portfolio and custom links
4. Review AI-extracted information
5. Add / correct experience, skills and projects
6. Set availability, location, salary and work preferences
7. Configure privacy and contact settings
8. Publish profile
9. Optionally purchase a boost
10. Monitor profile views and contact requests

11. Respond to employers

12. Track opportunities

Employer journey

13. Create employer account

14. Verify work email / company

15. Open Discover Talent

16. Search or browse a category

17. Apply filters

18. Open candidate profile

19. Review evidence and links

20. Contact candidate if permitted

21. Receive response

22. Move conversation toward interview / hire

Boost journey

23. Candidate opens Boost

24. System shows exact placement rules and duration

25. Candidate chooses category (and later, a bid if auctions are enabled)

26. Checkout

27. Server confirms successful payment by webhook

28. Boost is activated

29. Candidate sees placement and analytics

30. Boost automatically expires

31. Candidate can purchase again subject to anti-abuse limits

6. Information Architecture - Complete Page Inventory

Area	Page / route	Purpose	MVP
Public	/	Hero, value proposition, featured talent, browse CTA	Yes
Public	/talent	Browse/search talent	Yes
Public	/talent/[category]	Category talent board	Yes
Public	/p/[slug]	Candidate profile	Yes
Public	/for-candidates	Candidate acquisition page	Yes
Public	/for-employers	Employer acquisition page	Yes
Public	/how-it-works	Explain marketplace	Yes
Public	/pricing	Boost pricing	Yes
Public	/safety	Safety center	Yes
Public	/faq	Frequently asked questions	Yes
Public	/privacy	Privacy policy	Yes, legal review
Public	/terms	Terms	Yes, legal review
Public	/rules	Community / marketplace rules	Yes
Auth	/signup	Account creation	Yes
Auth	/login	Authentication	Yes
Candidate	/dashboard	Candidate overview	Yes
Candidate	/dashboard/profile	Profile editor	Yes
Candidate	/dashboard/import	Import sources	Yes
Candidate	/dashboard/boost	Boost purchase / status	Yes
Candidate	/dashboard/analytics	Visibility analytics	V1
Candidate	/dashboard/opportunities	Contacts and opportunities	Yes

Area	Page / route	Purpose	MVP
Candidate	/dashboard/settings	Account/privacy/settings	Yes
Employer	/employer	Employer dashboard	Yes
Employer	/employer/talent	Talent search	Yes
Employer	/employer/saved	Saved candidates	V1
Employer	/employer/messages	Messages	V1
Admin	/admin	Operations dashboard	Yes
Admin	/admin/users	User moderation	Yes
Admin	/admin/boosts	Boost/payment operations	Yes
Admin	/admin/reports	Safety reports	Yes
System	/404	Not found	Yes
System	/500	Server error	Yes

7. Homepage Requirements

Hero

Headline: “Back Yourself. Get Seen.”

Supporting copy: “Build your professional profile from your resume, LinkedIn, GitHub and portfolio. Put yourself in front of employers and get discovered.”

Primary CTA: Create Your Profile. Secondary CTA: Explore Talent.

Live talent board preview

Display a small set of featured and recently published candidates. Featured placement must be visibly labeled as paid visibility. Do not label featured candidates as “best” or imply a quality ranking.

How it works

Build -> Publish -> Back yourself -> Get discovered -> Talk.

Trust section

Show privacy controls, employer verification, reporting, and the rule that BEXO payments buy platform visibility only - never a job.

8. Candidate Profile Requirements

Header fields

- Photo / avatar
- Full name
- Professional headline
- Location
- Availability status
- Years of experience
- Primary role
- Work preference
- Featured label when active
- Contact CTA

Core profile sections

- About
- Work experience
- Projects
- Skills
- Skill evidence
- Education
- Certifications
- Achievements
- Resume
- LinkedIn
- GitHub
- Portfolio / custom links
- Salary expectations (optional)
- Availability
- Job preferences
- Contact settings

Profile quality rules

- Candidate must review imported information before publication.
- AI may suggest edits but must not invent facts.
- Every public claim should be attributable to user-provided or connected information.
- Candidate can reorder sections and feature selected projects.
- Profile must render well on mobile and desktop.
- Public profile should have a shareable URL.

9. Resume Import and AI

Resume upload

Support PDF and DOCX initially. Store the original file securely and create normalized structured data for the profile.

Extraction fields

- Name
- Headline
- Summary
- Companies
- Titles
- Employment dates
- Descriptions
- Skills
- Projects
- Education
- Certifications
- Awards

- Public links

Human-in-the-loop requirement

Extracted content enters a review step before it becomes public. The UI must explicitly tell the candidate that AI extraction can be imperfect.

AI enhancement

AI may recommend clearer descriptions, measurable outcomes, project summaries or skill categorization. Suggestions must be editable and attributable to the candidate.

No fabrication

The system must not create employers, dates, degrees, certifications, revenue, users, achievements or skills that are not supported by the input.

10. LinkedIn, GitHub, Portfolio and External Sources

LinkedIn

Candidate can always add a LinkedIn URL. Structured import should use an authorized integration if one is available. The MVP must not depend on unauthorized scraping.

GitHub

Use OAuth/API access where appropriate. Display profile URL and selected public repositories. Candidate chooses featured repositories.

Portfolio and custom links

Allow personal websites and professional platforms such as Behance, Dribbble, Figma, Kaggle, Medium, Product Hunt, YouTube, Notion and custom URLs.

11. Candidate Availability and Preferences

Field	Examples	Visibility
Availability	Immediately / 2 weeks / 30 days / 60+ days	Public or hidden
Job status	Actively looking / Open to opportunities / Not looking	Public or hidden
Employment type	Full-time / Part-time / Contract / Freelance / Internship	Public
Remote preference	Remote / Hybrid / On-site	Public
Salary range	\$80k-\$110k / INR range	Optional
Relocation	Yes / No / Selected countries	Optional
Industries	AI / SaaS / Fintech / etc.	Optional

12. Contact and Messaging

Default contact pattern

Use a Contact Candidate form as the default to reduce unsolicited exposure of email addresses. Candidate receives the message through BEXO notification/email relay.

Public email

Candidate may explicitly enable public email. The setting must be off by default.

Employer message

Employer enters name, company, work email, opportunity type, role and message. Require rate limits and abuse controls.

Future internal messaging

V1 can add in-product messaging. The candidate should be able to block an employer and report the conversation.

13. Talent Discovery and Search

Browse modes

- Featured talent
- Recently joined
- Recently updated
- Actively looking
- Category pages
- Remote
- Location-based

Search filters

- Role
- Skills
- Location
- Remote preference
- Experience
- Availability
- Employment type
- Compensation
- Industry
- Verification signals

Semantic search - V2

Allow recruiters to enter natural-language queries. The system should convert the query into explainable filters and ranking factors rather than an opaque hiring decision.

14. Featured Placement - Core Monetization

MVP product

Start with a fixed-price visibility product: \$10 for 24 hours of Featured placement in one selected category or board. The candidate can preview how the profile will appear before purchase.

What the purchase means

- Prominent placement on the selected board for the defined duration.
- Visible “Featured” or “Boosted” label.
- Visibility analytics for the active period.
- No promise of clicks, contacts, interviews, offers or jobs.

What the purchase does not mean

- No skill upgrade.
- No verification.
- No editorial endorsement.
- No guaranteed audience.
- No guaranteed top position unless the product explicitly sells top position for a specified duration.

15. Ranking and Boost Rules

MVP ranking

Use a simple featured shelf above the organic results. Within the featured shelf, order by boost start time or a transparent rotation. This is preferable to claiming that payment is a quality ranking.

Auction / outbid model - V2

After marketplace liquidity is proven, BEXO may introduce Pozy-style competitive placement. The UI can show a current minimum/target bid and allow a candidate to outbid another candidate for a defined category/time window.

Any auction must explicitly say that the ranking represents paid visibility, not candidate quality. Define bid increments, tie handling, end time, payment capture, cancellation, and whether a displaced candidate receives a refund or credit before implementation.

Anti-monopoly rules

- Maximum continuous featured duration per account
- Category-level frequency caps
- Identity/payment abuse checks
- No automated bid manipulation
- No self-view or click inflation
- Admin ability to pause suspicious boosts

16. Boost UX

32. Candidate opens Boost dashboard.

33. Show: current status, board/category, duration, exact price, visibility explanation.

34. Candidate clicks Pay \$10.
35. Payment provider checkout opens.
36. Server receives provider webhook and verifies payment.
37. Boost activates only after verified payment state.
38. Candidate sees Featured status, expiration time, and analytics.
39. System automatically expires placement.

17. Candidate Analytics

- Profile views
- Unique employer/visitor views where privacy policy permits
- Contact clicks
- Contact requests
- Resume views/downloads where enabled
- LinkedIn clicks
- GitHub clicks
- Portfolio clicks
- Boost impressions
- Boost-to-contact conversion

Do not overstate analytics precision. Some traffic, device and privacy controls can limit attribution.

18. Employer Experience

Employer account

- Name
- Role
- Company
- Work email
- Company website
- LinkedIn/company page
- Optional company profile
- Verification status

Candidate review

The employer can see the candidate profile, evidence, public links and available contact options subject to candidate privacy settings.

Save and shortlist - V1

Allow employers to save candidates and create private lists. Do not expose private notes to candidates.

19. Employer Trust and Verification

At minimum, verify work email and capture company website. Add stronger verification for higher-volume recruiters or suspicious accounts.

Signal	Meaning
Email verified	Email ownership confirmed
Company domain verified	Email/domain alignment or other configured check
LinkedIn/company link	External professional reference
Identity verification	Optional higher assurance
Verified employer	Only if defined criteria are actually met

20. Candidate Privacy and Safety

- Public profile switch
- Hide from search engines
- Hide email
- Hide phone
- Hide current employer
- Hide salary
- Anonymous mode - V2
- Block employer
- Delete account
- Export data
- Report profile / message

Public exposure should be explicit. A candidate must see what will be public before publishing. Public contact information is particularly sensitive and should be opt-in.

21. Trust, Safety and Moderation

Required rules

- No impersonation
- No fake credentials
- No stolen resumes
- No scams
- No harassment
- No illegal services
- No spam
- No misleading job claims
- No candidate or employer manipulation of metrics
- No requests for money in exchange for a job

Reporting

Every candidate profile and employer conversation must have a report action. Reports enter an admin queue with reason, reporter, target, timestamps and evidence.

Moderation flow

40. Automated pre-screening
41. Queue suspicious content
42. Human review

43. Action: warn / hide / suspend / remove

44. Appeal workflow

45. Audit log

Anti-scam copy

BEXO must clearly state: “You pay BEXO for profile visibility. You should never pay an employer to obtain a job.” The FTC warns job seekers not to pay for the promise of a job; this product distinction should be made prominent. [Source: FTC, see References.]

22. Payments and Refunds

Provider

Use a hosted payment provider. Stripe is appropriate for supported markets; Razorpay may be appropriate for India depending on the business entity and merchant setup. Provider fees, taxes, payout rules and eligibility must be re-checked at launch.

Payment integrity

- Create checkout session server-side
- Use provider webhook as source of truth for activation
- Store provider payment ID
- Idempotently process webhooks
- Handle failed / expired / refunded / disputed payments
- Never grant boost solely on a client-side success URL

Refund policy

Do not hard-code “no refunds” as a universal rule. The product should publish a clear commercial refund policy that is reviewed for the launch jurisdiction, provider rules and consumer-protection requirements.

Operationally, refunds may be granted for duplicate charges, platform failure, or legal requirements, even if ordinary voluntary refunds are excluded.

Tax

Determine whether boost sales are advertising/digital services for the applicable jurisdiction and configure tax collection/invoicing accordingly. Do not assume a single tax rate globally.

23. Legal and Compliance Checklist

This section is a product/legal checklist, not legal advice. Obtain counsel for the launch jurisdictions.

Area	Requirement	Product implication
Privacy	Applicable privacy law	Privacy notice, user controls, deletion/export, data minimization
GDPR where applicable	Lawful basis, rights, transparency, security	Consent/notice design, DSAR workflow, processor inventory
US state privacy laws where applicable	Disclosure/opt-out/deletion rights vary	Privacy settings and jurisdiction-aware processes
India privacy/payment	Review applicable DPDP/payment/tax rules at launch	Privacy notice, vendor contracts, payment compliance
Consumer protection	No deceptive “pay to get hired” messaging	Clearly describe boost as visibility

Area	Requirement	Product implication
Payments	Provider terms and chargeback handling	Webhook states, receipts, disputes
Employment laws	Platform role varies by jurisdiction	Counsel on marketplace vs recruiter obligations
Intellectual property	User content and external logos/links	Terms, takedown process, rights to display content
Age	Recommended 18+ for MVP	Age gate and terms
Data transfers	Cross-border storage/vendors	DPA/SCC or local transfer analysis where relevant

24. Security Requirements

- HTTPS/TLS everywhere
- Secure password hashing if passwords are used
- OAuth tokens stored securely
- Role-based access control
- Signed/private resume URLs
- Encryption at rest for sensitive data
- Secrets managed outside source code
- Rate limiting
- CSRF/XSS/SQL injection defenses
- Webhook signature verification
- Audit logging for admin actions
- Session invalidation and account recovery protections
- Regular dependency updates
- Backup and restore testing
- Security incident response procedure

25. Technical Architecture

Recommended MVP stack

- Frontend / public site: Next.js + TypeScript
- UI: Tailwind CSS with design tokens
- Backend: Next.js server actions/API routes or a dedicated Node service
- Database: PostgreSQL
- File storage: S3-compatible object storage
- Search: PostgreSQL full-text initially; pgvector/managed search later
- Auth: managed auth provider or secure OAuth/email implementation
- Payments: Stripe; Razorpay for India if required
- Email: transactional provider
- Analytics: PostHog or equivalent
- Monitoring: Sentry + infrastructure logs

Architecture principle

Keep the MVP as a modular monolith unless scale demands separation. The highest engineering risk is not raw scale; it is correctness around profile privacy, payments, search indexing, and moderation.

26. Core Data Model

Entity	Core fields
User	id, email, role, status, created_at
CandidateProfile	user_id, slug, name, headline, bio, location, availability, visibility, salary, preferences
Experience	candidate_id, company, title, start_date, end_date, description
Project	candidate_id, name, description, stack, live_url, github_url, media
Skill	candidate_id, name, proficiency_label, evidence_refs
Education	candidate_id, institution, degree, field, dates
Certification	candidate_id, issuer, credential_id, verify_url
ExternalLink	candidate_id, type, url, display_name
Resume	candidate_id, storage_key, original_name, parsed_version, visibility
Boost	candidate_id, category_id, amount, currency, start_at, end_at, status
Payment	user_id, provider, provider_payment_id, amount, currency, status
EmployerProfile	user_id, company, website, verification_status
Conversation	candidate_id, employer_id, status
Message	conversation_id, sender_id, body, created_at
Report	reporter_id, target_type, target_id, reason, status
AnalyticsEvent	user_id, anonymous_id, event_name, payload, timestamp
AuditLog	actor_id, action, target, metadata, timestamp

27. API Requirements

Authentication

- POST /auth/signup
- POST /auth/login
- POST /auth/logout
- POST /auth/oauth/callback

Candidate

- GET /me/profile
- PATCH /me/profile
- POST /me/resume
- POST /me/links
- POST /me/projects
- POST /me/experience
- POST /me/publish
- POST /me/boost/checkout
- GET /me/boosts
- GET /me/opportunities

Discovery

- GET /talent
- GET /talent/:slug
- GET /categories

- GET /search

Employer

- POST /employer/profile
- GET /employer/search
- POST /employer/saved
- POST /employer/contact
- GET /employer/conversations

Webhooks

- POST /webhooks/payment
- POST /webhooks/email
- POST /webhooks/auth

28. Analytics Event Taxonomy

Event	Meaning	Key properties
profile_created	Candidate profile first created	candidate_id
profile_published	Profile becomes discoverable	category, visibility
profile_viewed	Public profile opened	source, category
contact_opened	Contact form opened	candidate_id
contact_sent	Contact sent	candidate_id, employer_id
resume_viewed	Resume shown/downloaded	candidate_id
portfolio_clicked	External portfolio clicked	candidate_id, link_type
boost_checkout_started	Payment flow started	price, currency, category
boost_paid	Verified payment	payment_id, amount
boost_activated	Placement activated	boost_id
boost_expired	Placement ended	boost_id
report_created	Safety report	reason
candidate_hired	Optional self-reported outcome	source

29. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	MVP target
Performance	Public profile pages target LCP <= 2.5s on reasonable broadband
Availability	Target 99.5% monthly for MVP
Security	No critical known vulnerabilities at launch
Accessibility	Keyboard navigation, visible focus, semantic forms, reasonable WCAG alignment
SEO	Indexable public profiles only when candidate opts in; unique metadata
Mobile	All candidate and employer flows usable on modern mobile browsers
Observability	Errors, payments, authentication and admin actions logged
Backups	Automated database backups and restore test before launch

30. MVP Feature Matrix

Feature	Priority	Acceptance criterion
Candidate account	P0	Candidate can sign up, verify email and

Feature	Priority	Acceptance criterion
		log in
Resume upload	P0	PDF/DOCX uploads and securely stores file
Resume parsing	P0	Structured draft created and manually confirmed
Rich profile	P0	Candidate can edit all core sections
External links	P0	LinkedIn/GitHub/portfolio/custom URLs supported
Public profile	P0	Shareable profile URL works and respects visibility
Talent search	P0	Employer can search/filter candidates
Candidate profile view	P0	Employer can inspect public information
Contact flow	P0	Employer can send a permitted contact message
Boost purchase	P0	Candidate can purchase \$10/24h visibility boost
Payment verification	P0	Boost activates only after verified provider event
Boost analytics	P1	Candidate can see impressions/views during boost
Employer verification	P0	Work email verified before outbound contact at scale
Moderation/reporting	P0	Users can report profiles and admins can act
Admin dashboard	P0	Operators can manage users, reports, boosts and payments
Internal messaging	P1	In-product conversation available
Dynamic auction	P2	Competitive bidding with explicit rules

31. Detailed Acceptance Criteria

Candidate publishing

- Cannot publish without minimum required fields.
- Candidate must see preview before publishing.
- Candidate must choose public/search visibility.
- Candidate can remove public email visibility at any time.
- Deleted profile becomes unavailable publicly within the defined SLA.

Boost

- Price is shown before checkout.
- Duration is shown before checkout.
- Category/board is shown before checkout.
- Successful boost is tied to a verified payment record.
- Boost expires automatically.
- Duplicate webhook delivery does not create duplicate boosts.
- Candidate can see active boost state.

Employer contact

- Blocked employer cannot contact candidate.
- Private email is never exposed through API payloads.
- Contact form is rate limited.

- Candidate receives notification after a successful message.

32. Product Metrics and Success Criteria

North Star

Qualified opportunities generated per active candidate. A qualified opportunity is an employer/recruiter contact that passes platform anti-spam rules and is not immediately reported as abusive.

Primary funnel

Visitor -> candidate profile view -> contact opened -> contact sent -> candidate response -> interview -> hire.

Candidate metrics

- Profile completion rate
- Publish rate
- Boost purchase conversion
- Boost repeat rate
- Views per profile
- Contacts per active candidate
- Response rate
- Interview rate
- Self-reported hire rate

Employer metrics

- Employer activation
- Searches per employer
- Profile views
- Contacts sent
- Response rate
- Saved candidates
- Interviews
- Hires

Paid visibility metrics

- Boost purchase rate
- Revenue per active candidate
- Incremental views vs non-boost baseline
- Incremental contact rate vs baseline
- Refund/dispute rate

33. Marketplace Liquidity Strategy

The largest business risk is a two-sided marketplace starting with insufficient employer demand. The initial launch should therefore be narrow.

- Start with one professional category (recommended: software / AI).
- Recruit an initial cohort of real candidates before broad paid acquisition.

- Recruit a small group of employers/founders who agree to browse the board.
- Keep candidate profiles free.
- Use the \$10 boost only after there is evidence that candidate exposure produces real employer attention.
- Expand categories only after repeat activity appears.

34. Go-To-Market Experiments

Experiment	Hypothesis	Measure
Candidate willingness to pay	Candidates value prominent visibility enough to pay \$10	Purchase rate
Employer discovery	Employers will browse people without first posting a role	Search and profile-view activity
Boost ROI	Boosted candidates get more meaningful contacts	Incremental contact rate
Niche launch	Concentrated category creates better liquidity	Candidate-to-employer connection rate
Public sharing	Candidates share profiles externally	Profile referral traffic
Anonymous mode	Privacy increases passive-candidate supply	Activation and publish rate

35. Competitive and Reference Check

Pozy

Pozy is the clearest mechanic reference. Its current public copy describes a pay-to-rank job board; its rules state that rank is bought, the board is ordered by bid, and payment is for placement rather than a guaranteed result. Its rules also describe minimum bids, ties, and restrictions on fake/scam listings. BEXO should borrow the general concept of paid visibility while changing the marketplace object from a job to a candidate.

OpenForHire

OpenForHire demonstrates the adjacent candidate-first model: candidates publish profiles and employers search for available people. BEXO must differentiate through its paid candidate visibility mechanic and stronger marketplace presentation.

Mirajobs / ReferNext and similar products

These adjacent products show that employer-initiated discovery is a real product pattern. BEXO therefore cannot claim novelty merely from “employers contact candidates”; the novel layer to validate is candidate-paid prominence on a public talent board.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn already supports candidate visibility signals and recruiter discovery. BEXO should position itself as a focused candidate marketplace rather than a social network.

36. What Is Actually Novel vs Existing

Capability	Already exists?	BEXO opportunity
Public candidate profile	Yes	Better marketplace UX and evidence
Resume + portfolio profile	Yes	Unified profile generation
Employer-initiated contact	Yes	Make this the core loop

Capability	Already exists?	BEXO opportunity
Open-to-work signal	Yes	Candidate-controlled marketplace status
Candidate-paid profile promotion	Adjacent / limited	Core differentiator
Candidate featured board	Rare / differentiated	Core differentiator
Pozy-style competitive candidate visibility	Not established as a dominant category	Potential V2 differentiator
Payment as voluntary confidence signal	Conceptual product positioning	Validate carefully

37. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
No employer demand	High	Narrow launch; recruit employers before monetization
Candidates do not pay	High	Test \$5/\$10/\$15 price points
Paid ranking feels unfair	High	Label as visibility, not quality; preserve organic discovery
Spam / scams	High	Employer verification, rate limits, reporting, moderation
Privacy leakage	High	Private-by-default contact data, access controls
Fake credentials	High	Verification signals, reporting, evidence links
Chargebacks	Medium	Clear product description, provider fraud controls
Legal/compliance gaps	High	Jurisdiction-specific legal review before launch
Auction complexity	Medium	Fixed-price MVP first
Marketplace dominated by spenders	Medium	Category quotas, frequency caps, organic section

38. Recommended Build Order

Phase 0 - validation

46. Landing page
47. Candidate profile prototype
48. Employer browse prototype
49. Manual candidate onboarding
50. Interview 10-20 candidates and 5-10 employers
51. Test whether users understand “pay for visibility”

Phase 1 - MVP build

52. Auth
53. Candidate profile
54. Resume upload + parser
55. External links
56. Public profile
57. Talent browse/search
58. Employer account
59. Contact flow

60. Payments

61. \$10 boost

62. Moderation

63. Admin

64. Analytics

Phase 2 - improve liquidity

65. Employer verification

66. Saved candidates

67. In-app messaging

68. Better search

69. Candidate analytics

70. Profile sharing/SEO

71. Anonymous mode

Phase 3 - marketplace depth

72. Dynamic outbid model

73. Bid history / rules

74. Employer subscriptions

75. Skill evidence

76. AI search

77. Interview scheduling

78. Offer workflows

39. Recommended MVP Product Copy

Context	Copy
Hero	Back Yourself. Get Seen.
Subheadline	Build your professional profile. Put yourself in front of employers.
Boost CTA	Boost My Profile - \$10
Boost explanation	Featured visibility for 24 hours. This boosts placement, not your qualifications.
Featured badge	Featured
Contact CTA	Contact Candidate
Safety	You pay BEXO for visibility - never pay an employer to get a job.
Candidate status	Actively looking
Employer CTA	Discover Talent

40. Design System Direction

Recommended palette

Token	Hex	Use
Ink	#111318	Primary text, navigation, strong surfaces
Warm background	#F7F7F2	Primary page background
Electric lime	#C8FF3D	Boost, featured, primary action accents
Violet	#7C5CFC	Secondary accent / links / selected states
Muted text	#667085	Secondary text
Success	#21C77A	Availability / success states

Token	Hex	Use
Warning	#FFB020	Warnings
Error	#FF4D5E	Error / report states

Visual principle: the product should feel like a modern talent market, not generic enterprise HR software. Keep lime reserved for actions and visibility signals. Avoid using payment-derived color as a false quality indicator.

41. Recommended Technical Delivery Checklist

- Repository + CI/CD
- Environment management
- Database migrations
- Seed/demo data
- Authentication
- Object storage
- Resume upload limits and malware scanning
- Search indexes
- Payment integration + webhooks
- Email delivery
- Analytics instrumentation
- Error monitoring
- Admin RBAC
- Moderation workflow
- Privacy controls
- Backup/restore test
- Security review
- Accessibility pass
- Mobile QA
- SEO metadata
- Load test public profile/search pages

42. Release Gates

Gate	Must be true before launch
Product	Candidate can create and publish a complete profile
Marketplace	Employer can discover and open profiles
Contact	Employer can contact candidate within privacy settings
Payment	\$10 boost purchase activates reliably via verified payment event
Safety	Report + moderation path works
Privacy	Public/private fields are technically enforced
Operations	Admin can suspend accounts and inspect payments
Analytics	Core funnel events are measured
Legal	Terms/privacy/payment copy reviewed for launch market
Reliability	Backups and recovery tested

43. Open Decisions Before Development Freeze

- Final brand name after trademark/domain clearance.
- Launch country and corresponding payment/tax/privacy configuration.
- Whether public email is permitted at launch or contact form only.
- Exact boost duration and category behavior.
- Whether featured placement is a shelf or a precise rank.
- Whether V2 uses fixed-price rotation or live outbidding.
- Employer access: public browse vs account required.
- Verification level required before employer contact.
- Candidate anonymity policy.

44. Final Product Definition

BEXO is a candidate-first visibility marketplace. A person creates a professional profile once, connects the work and evidence they already have, and decides how publicly they want to be discovered. A small paid boost can put that profile in a prominent position for a defined period. Employers then judge the person based on their actual experience and work and can contact them directly.

The key product principle is simple: money buys visibility; work earns credibility.

The best first version is deliberately small: free profiles, public talent discovery, direct contact, strong privacy/safety controls, and one transparent \$10 boost. Only after real employer demand and candidate willingness to pay are demonstrated should BEXO introduce competitive bidding, subscriptions, AI matching, or a broader hiring workflow.

45. Research Notes and Sources

The following sources were checked during product verification. They are included so the product team can revisit the underlying evidence. External facts and provider pricing can change; re-check at implementation and launch.

Pozy homepage: <https://pozy.ai/> - Pay-to-rank hiring board positioning and current product concept.

Pozy rules / terms: <https://pozy.ai/static/rules.html> - Current ranking rules, paid placement framing, prohibited content and payment/refund language.

OpenForHire: <https://www.openforhire.net/> - Candidate-first profile and employer discovery pattern.

Mirajobs: <https://mirajobs.com/> - Employer-initiated candidate discovery pattern.

ReferNext talent: <https://www.refernext.com/talent> - Candidate marketplace and privacy/identity disclosure pattern.

LinkedIn recruiter visibility help: <https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a507508/making-your-profile-visible-or-hidden-from-recruiters> - Current candidate visibility / Open to Work controls.

LinkedIn recruiter solutions: <https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a7134286> - Recruiter discovery context.

FTC job scams: <https://consumer.ftc.gov/articles/job-scams> - Warning against paying for a job and common job-scam patterns.

FTC work-from-home scams: <https://consumer.ftc.gov/consumer-alerts/2025/06/how-avoid-work-home-job-scams> - Job scam prevention.

Stripe pricing: <https://stripe.com/pricing> - Payment pricing should be rechecked for launch country and account type.

Stripe Checkout: <https://docs.stripe.com/payments/checkout> - Hosted payment implementation reference.

Razorpay pricing: <https://razorpay.com/pricing/> - India payment pricing reference; verify current merchant eligibility/fees.

EU data protection: https://commission.europa.eu/law/law-topic/data-protection/information-individuals_en - High-level individual privacy rights reference.

GDPR retention guidance: <https://usercentrics.com/knowledge-hub/gdpr-data-retention/> - Secondary reference on storage limitation; legal review still required.

Appendix A - Example Candidate Profile

Rahul Sharma | AI Engineer | 4 years | Bangalore | Remote | Actively looking

Summary: AI engineer building production software and LLM applications.

Skills: Python, LLMs, RAG, AWS, React, PostgreSQL

Experience: Company A - AI Engineer; Startup B - Software Engineer

Projects: AI customer support agent; RAG knowledge platform; internal automation system

Links: LinkedIn, GitHub, Portfolio

Contact: Contact form enabled; email hidden

Featured status: Featured - \$10 visibility boost, 24 hours

Appendix B - Example Employer Contact

Sarah Johnson | Hiring Manager | Acme AI | sarah@acme.ai | AI Engineer role

“Hi Rahul, your experience with RAG and LLM applications looks relevant to a role on our AI platform team. We would like to discuss the opportunity.”